HOUSE HACKING ATLANTA

The Four Numbers

Run these before you get excited about any property. Twenty minutes. Each one can end the analysis.

PROPERTY	ASKING PRICE	DOWN PAYMENT %

1 WHAT IT ACTUALLY COSTS TO OWN

Principal & interest	$
Property taxes — verify; not what the seller pays	$
Insurance — ask about renting part of it	$
Mortgage insurance — if applicable	$
HOA	$
Utilities you'll cover	$
Maintenance reserve	$
TOTAL COST TO OWN	**$**

If this matches what the mortgage calculator told you, **you left something out.**

2 REALISTIC RENTAL INCOME

First, define the product

- ☐ Private entrance / Shared entrance
- ☐ Private bath / Shared bath
- ☐ Private kitchen / Kitchenette / Shared
- ☐ Furnished / Unfurnished
- ☐ Utilities included / Separate
- ☐ Long-term / Mid-term / Short-term

Then pull five comps that match

Zillow · Facebook Marketplace · SpareRoom · Furnished Finder · Airbnb *filtered to monthly* · VRBO
Use the monthly rate on nightly platforms — never the nightly price × 30.

#	SOURCE	WHAT IT IS	RENT	RENTED FAST?
1			$	
2			$	
3			$	

4	$
5	$

Drop the highest and lowest. Middle number: ____________

Adjust up if:

private entrance · private bath · in-unit laundry · dedicated parking · extra storage · furnished

Adjust down if:

shared bath · poor light · no parking · awkward access · small or odd shape

Adjusted rent per space	$
× number of spaces	
Less vacancy allowance (____ %)	$
REALISTIC MONTHLY INCOME	**$**

> You will never regret underwriting a deal on a number you comfortably beat.

3 YOUR EFFECTIVE HOUSING COST

Number 1 — cost to own	$
Less Number 2 — realistic income	$
EFFECTIVE HOUSING COST	**$**
What would you otherwise pay in rent?	$
THE GAP ← this is your savings rate	**$**

- ☐ **Beats my alternative** → keep going
- ☐ **Doesn't** → stop here

> **Zero was never the benchmark.** Paying less than market rent while building equity is a win, even if the number isn't zero.

4 WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE WHEN YOU MOVE OUT

Rent for the space you're living in	$
Total rent — whole property	$
Less total cost to own (Number 1)	$
COVERS ITSELF?	**$**

- ☐ **Yes** → this is a house hack *and* a future rental
- ☐ **No** → it works while you live there. That can be fine — just know it going in.

THE DECISION

- [ ] **All four work** → worth a walkthrough
- [ ] Number 1 was higher than expected → recheck, then likely pass
- [ ] Number 2 was lower than hoped → recheck comps, then likely pass
- [ ] Number 3 doesn't beat renting → pass
- [ ] Number 4 doesn't work and I'm not okay with that → pass

MY ASSUMPTIONS — WRITE THESE DOWN

Rent assumption came from

Vacancy % used

Maintenance reserve %

Anything I'm unsure about

> Six months from now you'll want to know whether you were consistent — or whether you talked yourself into a better number the second time.

> **Practice habit:** run this on one listing a week that you have no intention of buying. After ten or fifteen, you'll see the answer before you finish — and stop wasting time on properties that were never going to work.

Every door is an opportunity.

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